

Shopping



Grammar Focus	Topic Focus
Modal Verbs	**Discussing Shopping**
Making assumptions	Types of shops in English
Making requests	Types of Shopping
Too & Enough	**Shopping Vocabulary**
	In the sales
	At the shop
	Clothes and accessories

Centro Linguistico di Ateneo
Excellence in Linguistic Training

Types of Shops in English

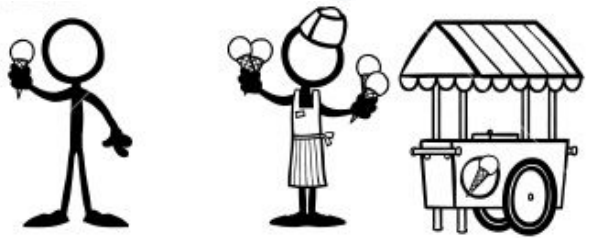




Baker – sells fresh bread and cakes.
Bicycle dealer – a shop that sells bicycles.
Bookshop / **Bookstore** – sells books.
Butcher – sells fresh meat.
Car dealer(ship) – sells cars.
Chemist (UK) / **Drugstore** (US) – sells medicines and toiletries.
Clothes shop – sells clothing.
Corner shop (UK) – a shop on the corner of your street, that sells a variety of basic goods – food, newspapers, sweets, bread, etc.
Delicatessen (**Deli**) – sells a selection of fine, unusual or foreign prepared foods not normally found in supermarkets. For example, an Italian deli, an Asian deli.
Department store – a shop that sells many different items in different departments. Harrods is probably the world's best known department store.
DIY (**Do It Yourself**) **store** – sells things for home improvement.

Types of Shops in English

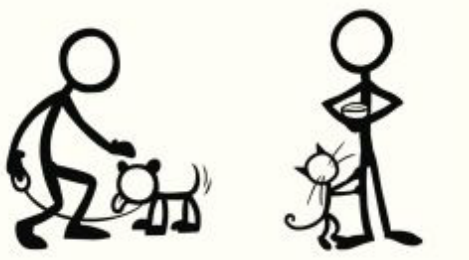
Farmer's Market – a market where farmers have stalls that sell the fresh fruit and vegetables, fresh eggs and other food that they produce on their farms.
Fishmonger – sells fresh fish.
Flea market – a group of stalls that sell old furniture and clothes.
Flower shop / **Florist** - a shop that sells flowers and flower arrangements.
Greengrocer – sells fresh fruit and vegetables.
Grocer (UK) / **Grocery store** (US) – a shop that sells food.



Hairdresser's / **Barber's** – shops where you can get your hair cut and styled, and get a shave.
Hardware shop / **hardware store** – sells hardware goods, such as nails and screws.
Ice cream parlour – a shop where you can buy ice cream.
Jewellery shop – a shop where you can buy jewels, such as rings, bracelets and necklaces.
Market – market traders (people who work on a market) have stalls that sell fruit and vegetables, clothes, household items and so on.
Music shop – a shop that sells CDs, records, musical instruments and musical scores.
Motorcycle dealer – sells motorcycles

Types of Shops in English

Newsagent – sells newspapers and magazines.
Optician – sells glasses / contact lenses.
Pastry shop / Patisserie – a shop where you can buy cakes, pastries and sweet baked goods.
Petrol station (UK) / **Gas station** (US) sells petrol, car products and sometimes food.
Pet store (or shop) – for pets and pet food.
Pharmacy (US) – sells medicines.
Shoe shop – sells shoes
Shopping Centre (UK) / **Mall** (US) – a large building with a lot of shops, restaurants, cafés and sometimes a cinema.
Stationer – sells paper goods.
Supermarket – a large shop that sells mostly food and household items.
Tea shop (UK) – like a café, but sells tea and cakes.
Tobacconist – sells cigarettes, cigars, pipes and tobacco.
Toy shop – sells all kinds of toys.
Travel agent's – a shop where people can plan holidays and make travel arrangements.





Shopping

Shopping can be a very pleasant experience, because many people simply adore shopping.

A list of **shopper types** has been developed by researchers which identifies a particular group of shoppers as **recreational shoppers**, that is, those who enjoy shopping and view it as a leisure activity.

The modern phenomenon of **shopping for pleasure** is closely linked to the rise of the middle class in XVII and XVIII-century Europe. While in the early ages shopping was associated with the need to obtain vital supplies, in the XVII century, with the improvement of standards of living, consumers from a broad range of social backgrounds began to purchase goods that were unessential, in excess of basic necessities.

The use of **glass windows** in shop-fronts gave rise to **window shopping** as a recreational activity. By the late XVIII century, grand **shopping arcades** began to emerge across Britain and in Europe.

The XVIII century arcades have become today the great **shopping hubs** of the world, such as **Harrods**, in London, that through its slogans promises consumers to find them anything on the planet. Its mottos "***from the pin to the elephant***" and "***Omnia Omnibus Ubique"***, "**everything for everyone, everywhere"**, indicate the extreme variety of items that it offers for sale.

Shopping Frenzy

Shopping frenzies are periods of time when a **burst of spending occurs**, typically near the holidays, with **Christmas shopping** being the biggest shopping spending season, starting as early as October and continuing until well after Christmas.

A particular shopping event is called **Black Friday**. This is the day after Thanksgiving, an American festivity which falls on the fourth Thursday of November. On Black Friday, shops put a variety of items on sale, hoping to **turn a profit**, thus going from being "**in the red**" to being "**in the black**". Many stores offer highly promoted sales on Black Friday and open very early, even at midnight, as many shoppers are already in line at Thanksgiving, waiting to enter to **strike a bargain**.





Online Shopping

Online shopping is another way to shop and sometimes save money, as items sold via the Internet are often less expensive than in the stores, not to mention the fact that they are delivered right to your **doorstep**!
It is a form of electronic commerce, or **e-commerce**, which allows consumers to buy goods or services directly from a seller over the Internet, using a web browser. Consumers search for products they are interested in by visiting the website of the retailer or by searching among alternative vendors using a shopping search engine, which displays the product's availability and pricing at different e-retailers.

It is true that you cannot try on the garment or shoes, or that you cannot examine your purchase before paying for it, but online sellers offer a **30-day money-back guarantee** and should exchange the item or give you **full refund**, if it is damaged or not to your liking.

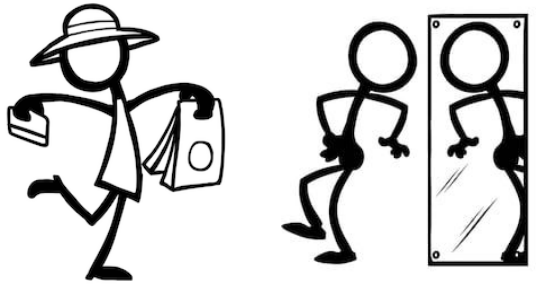
Cyber Monday has become the online equivalent to Black Friday. It falls on the Monday after Black Friday, and offers a way for smaller retail websites to compete with larger chains. Since its beginning, it has become an international marketing term used by online retailers across the world.

Personal Shoppers

Many people don't like shopping at all, because they find it quite stressful. It is often difficult to find the right garment or shoe size, and many designer brands do not carry sizes for curvy people.

Having a **personal shopper** could be a great idea, because he or she could make a selection of shops based on your individual needs, so as not to have to hopelessly go from one shop to another.

A personal shopper is a person who helps people to shop by giving advice and making suggestions. Their focus is usually on clothes. A **personal stylist**, instead, advises individuals on new fashion trends, clothing styles, colours and makeup, offering the full shopping experience and, perhaps, making it a little less stressful!



Shopping Vocabulary – "In the sales"

Here's some useful shopping vocabulary to find a **bargain** in the **sales**.

December 26 (or Boxing Day) is traditionally the beginning of the **winter sales in the UK**, when items are heavily **discounted**.

In fact, **bargain hunters** can find some items reduced up to **50% off** their **pre-sale price**.

Unbeatable offer / **prices slashed** (cut) or **give-away prices** mean **very low prices**.

Clearance Sale / **Everything must go!** are signs in shop windows **advertising the sales.**

To snap up a bargain means to buy something at a **very cheap price**.



Shopping Vocabulary – "At the shop"

What a sales person says
"Can I help you?"
"Are you looking for anything in particular?"

Asking about things in shops
"Do you have any…?"
"I'm looking for…"
"I wonder if you could help me…?"
"Do you have this in another size?"
"Do you have this in another colour?"
"Is this made of leather / silk / plastic…?"
"Does this come with a guarantee?"
"Is this fully refundable?"
"Can I bring this back if it's not the right size?"
"Can I bring this back if it doesn't fit?"

Your reply
"I'm just looking, thank you."
"I'm just browsing, thank you."

What the shopkeeper says
"I'm sorry, we're out of stock."
"I'm sorry, that's the last one."
"I'm sorry, that's all we have left."
"What is your size?" (for clothes)
"What is your shoe size?" (for shoes, boots, etc.)

Paying – what the shopkeeper says
"Do you have anything smaller?" (If you pay with a large denomination banknote.)
"Would you prefer to pay in cash or by card?"
"Thank you, and please come again!"



Paying – what you say
"I'm sorry, I don't have any small change."
"I don't have anything smaller."
"Would you have change for this?"
"Can I have the receipt, please?'
"Can I pay by credit card?"
"Can I pay in cash?"
"Is this on sale?"

Shopping Vocabulary – "Clothes and Accessories"

FOR HIM

Jacket
Coat
Trousers
Jeans
Shorts
Suit
Waistcoat (UK) / Vest (US)
Shirt
T-shirt
Jumper (UK) / Sweater (US)
Tie

Nightwear

Pyjamas
Robe

Swimwear

Swim trunks
Trunks

Underwear

Pants (UK)
Briefs, Trunks, Boxer shorts (US)
Socks
Vest (UK)

At the gym

Sweat suit

Footwear

Shoes
Boots
Slippers
Flip-flops
Trainers (UK) / Sneakers (US)
Sandals

Accessories

Scarf
Gloves
Belt
Man bag
Wallet
Hat
Cap



FOR HER

Jacket
Coat
Pants
Jeans
Shorts
Pantsuit
Skirt
Dress
Blouse
T-shirt

Nightwear

Nightgown
Baby doll
Pyjamas
Robe

Swimwear

One-piece swimsuit
Bikini
Tankini

Underwear

Slip
Bra
Knickers (UK) / Panties (US)
Socks
Stockings

At the gym

Sweat suit

Footwear

Shoes
High-heeled shoes
Boots
Slippers
Flip-flops
Trainers (UK) / Sneakers (US)
Sandals

Accessories

Scarf
Gloves
Belt
Handbag
Purse
Hat



Shopping Vocabulary – "Objects and Gifts"
What can you buy and where can you buy them?

At the jewellers'
Bracelets
Necklaces
Rings
Pendants
Watches

At the deli's
Particular foods
Special wines

At the pastry shop/patisserie
Cakes
Pastries

At the ice cream parlour
Ice cream

At the music shop
CDs
Vinyl records
Musical scores
Musical instruments

At the travel agent's
A trip or a journey

At the clothes' shop
Clothes for him
Clothes for her
Accessories

At the florists'
A flower arrangement
A plant

At the shoe shop
Shoes in general
Handbags
Belts

At the toy shop
Toys in general
Puzzles
Dolls
Toy cars

At the bookstore
Books
Posters